

1. Introduction

Welcome to **SpareXchange Privacy Policy**. This Privacy Policy explains how SpareXchange (“SpareXchange,” “we,” “our,” or “us”) collects, uses, stores, processes, protects, and manages personal information obtained through the use of the SpareXchange platform, including related services, features, and functionalities.

SpareXchange recognizes the importance of privacy and is committed to ensuring the responsible, transparent, and secure handling of personal data collected from users of the platform. We understand that trust is essential in creating a reliable digital environment for spare part exchange, technician coordination, recycling activities, and community engagement. Accordingly, SpareXchange seeks to implement reasonable technical and organizational measures to protect user information from unauthorized access, misuse, disclosure, alteration, or loss.

The purpose of this Privacy Policy is to:

- Explain what information SpareXchange collects;
- Describe how information is collected and processed;
- Clarify how information is used and protected;
- Inform users about their rights and responsibilities regarding personal data;
- Provide transparency regarding information sharing and system operations.

This Privacy Policy applies to all individuals and entities accessing or using SpareXchange, including:

- Standard Users
- Verified Users
- Technicians

- Recyclers
- Administrators

By accessing, registering for, or using SpareXchange, users acknowledge that they have read, understood, and accepted the practices described in this Privacy Policy. Users who do not agree with this Policy should discontinue use of the platform.

SpareXchange may periodically update this Privacy Policy to reflect operational, legal, technical, or security changes. Updated versions may be communicated through the platform or published on official pages.

2. Definitions

For clarity and consistency, the following terms used in this Privacy Policy shall have the meanings assigned below:

2.1 Personal Data

“**Personal Data**” refers to any information that directly or indirectly identifies an individual user or can reasonably be associated with a specific person.

Personal Data may include:

- Full name;
- Email address;
- Phone number;

- Account credentials;
 - Verification information;
 - Profile information;
 - Usage records.
-

2.2 Processing

“**Processing**” refers to any operation performed on user information, whether automated or manual.

This may include:

- Collection;
 - Recording;
 - Storage;
 - Organization;
 - Retrieval;
 - Modification;
 - Analysis;
 - Sharing;
 - Deletion.
-

2.3 User

A “**User**” refers to any person who accesses, browses, registers, or interacts with SpareXchange and its functionalities.

Users may include:

- Standard Users
 - Verified Users
 - Technicians
 - Recyclers
 - Administrators
-

2.4 Verified User

A “**Verified User**” refers to a registered user whose identity or required supporting documentation has been reviewed and approved by SpareXchange to access additional functionalities or privileges.

Verification may permit access to features such as spare listing creation or eco-point redemption.

2.5 Technician

A “**Technician**” refers to an approved user who offers technical support, repair, maintenance, or consultation services through the platform.

Technicians operate independently and are not employees or representatives of SpareXchange.

2.6 Recycler

A “**Recycler**” refers to an approved individual or organization involved in recycling, refurbishing, responsible disposal, or environmentally sustainable management of spare parts or related materials through SpareXchange.

2.7 Administrator

An “**Administrator**” refers to an authorized platform manager responsible for system monitoring, verification review, moderation, dispute handling, security management, and enforcement of platform policies.

Administrative access is restricted and controlled.

2.8 Cookies

“**Cookies**” refer to small text files stored on a user’s device that help improve platform functionality, maintain user sessions, remember preferences, and support secure authentication processes.

Cookies may be temporary (session-based) or persistent.

2.9 Authentication

“**Authentication**” refers to the process of verifying a user’s identity to allow secure access to platform services.

Authentication may include:

- Username and password validation;
 - Login session management;
 - Authentication tokens;
 - Security verification measures.
-

2.10 Third-Party Services

“**Third-Party Services**” refer to external systems, technologies, or service providers integrated into SpareXchange to support functionality.

Examples may include:

- Cloud hosting services;
- Map and geolocation services;
- File storage systems;
- Notification or communication systems.

Third-party services may maintain independent privacy practices.

2.11 Eco-Points

“**Eco-Points**” refer to non-monetary digital incentive points awarded to users for participating in approved recycling activities or environmentally responsible behavior within SpareXchange.

Eco-points:

- Have no cash value;

- Are non-transferable;
 - Cannot be exchanged for legal currency.
-

2.12 Verification Documents

“**Verification Documents**” refer to files, credentials, licenses, identification materials, or supporting documents submitted by users for verification purposes.

Such documents may be reviewed to determine eligibility for restricted platform functionalities.

3. Information We Collect

SpareXchange collects information necessary to provide, maintain, improve, secure, and manage platform functionalities.

The type of information collected depends on how users interact with the platform and the services they access.

3.1 Personal Information

SpareXchange may collect basic personal information necessary for user identification, communication, and account management.

This may include:

- Full name;
- Email address;
- Phone number;
- Profile image (if provided);
- User role information;
- Geographic or location-related information where applicable.

Personal information is collected primarily during registration, profile updates, verification, or communication with the platform.

3.2 Account Information

To support secure access and authentication, SpareXchange may collect account-related information.

This may include:

- Username;
- Encrypted or hashed password credentials;
- Login history;
- Authentication status;
- Password reset activity;
- Account preferences;
- Session information.

For security purposes, SpareXchange does not intentionally store passwords in readable or plain-text format.

3.3 Verification Information

Users seeking additional privileges, technician access, or recycler participation may be required to submit verification-related information.

Verification information may include:

- Identity documents;
- Licenses or certifications;
- Supporting documentation;
- Verification photos;
- Role-specific eligibility materials.

Verification information is used solely for platform trust, security, and eligibility review purposes.

SpareXchange may restrict access to authorized administrators involved in verification review.

3.4 Listing and Activity Data

SpareXchange may collect information related to platform activities and user interactions.

This may include:

Spare Listing Data

- Spare listing title;
- Description;
- Category;
- Item condition;
- Uploaded images;
- Listing status.

Technician Activity

- Technician requests;
- Service availability;
- Communication history related to service coordination.

Recycling Activity

- Recycling submissions;
- Recyclable item details;
- Validation records;
- Eco-point history.

Dispute and Reporting Information

- User complaints;
- Submitted reports;
- Evidence or supporting documents;
- Moderation records.

This information helps facilitate platform operations, dispute resolution, and trust management.

3.5 Device and Usage Information

To improve platform security, reliability, and performance, SpareXchange may automatically collect limited technical information during use.

This may include:

- Internet Protocol (IP) address;
- Browser type;
- Device type;
- Operating system information;
- Login timestamps;
- Platform interaction logs;
- Error or activity logs.

This information is primarily used for:

- Security monitoring;
- Fraud prevention;
- Troubleshooting;
- Performance optimization;
- System maintenance.

SpareXchange seeks to collect only information reasonably necessary for legitimate platform operations.

4. How We Collect Information

SpareXchange collects information through various interactions and activities performed on the platform.

Information may be collected directly from users, automatically through system usage, or through platform-related processes necessary to support functionality, security, and service delivery.

The methods through which information may be collected are described below.

4.1 Information Collected During Registration

When users create an account on SpareXchange, certain information may be collected to establish and manage the account.

This may include:

- Full name;
- Email address;
- Phone number;
- Username;
- Password credentials;
- Selected user role.

Registration information is collected to enable account creation, authentication, and platform access.

Users are expected to provide accurate and up-to-date information during registration.

4.2 Information Collected Through Profile Updates

Users may voluntarily update or modify profile information after account creation.

Additional information may be collected when users:

- Update personal information;
- Modify account preferences;
- Upload profile images;
- Change contact details;
- Edit role-related information.

Profile updates help maintain accurate platform records and improve service functionality.

4.3 Information Collected During Verification

Certain platform functionalities require user verification.

When users apply for verification, SpareXchange may collect:

- Identification documents;
- Professional credentials;
- Licenses or certifications;
- Supporting files;
- Verification-related communications.

Verification information is collected solely for trust, eligibility assessment, fraud prevention, and platform security purposes.

Access to verification materials may be restricted to authorized administrators.

4.4 Information Collected Through Spare Listings

When users create or manage spare listings, SpareXchange may collect information associated with those listings.

This may include:

- Spare item title;
- Description;
- Category information;
- Condition details;
- Uploaded images;
- Listing availability status.

Listing-related information supports search, filtering, user interaction, and exchange coordination.

4.5 Information Collected Through Technician and Recycler Requests

Information may be collected when users interact with technician or recycler functionalities.

For technician-related services, collected information may include:

- Service requests;
- Repair descriptions;
- Availability preferences;
- Communication records.

For recycling-related activities, collected information may include:

- Recycling submissions;
- Recyclable material details;
- Recycler interactions;
- Eco-point updates.

This information enables service coordination and platform functionality.

4.6 Information Collected Through Disputes and Reports

Users may voluntarily submit information when reporting issues or disputes.

This may include:

- Complaint details;
- Supporting evidence;
- Uploaded files or screenshots;
- Communication records;
- Moderation-related information.

Dispute-related information is collected to support fair resolution, moderation, and platform trust.

4.7 Information Automatically Collected During Platform Use

SpareXchange may automatically collect limited technical and usage information during platform interactions.

Automatically collected information may include:

- IP address;
- Browser type;
- Device type;
- Login timestamps;
- Session information;
- Error logs;
- Activity logs.

Automatic collection supports:

- Security monitoring;
- Fraud detection;
- Performance optimization;
- Troubleshooting;
- System reliability.

SpareXchange seeks to collect only information reasonably necessary for legitimate operational purposes.

5. Purpose of Data Collection (Why We Use Data)

SpareXchange collects and processes information to provide secure, reliable, and effective platform services. Information is used only for legitimate operational, security, administrative, and functional purposes necessary for platform performance.

The purposes for which user information may be used are described below.

5.1 Account Management

SpareXchange uses collected information to manage user accounts and support account-related functionalities.

This may include:

Authentication

- Verifying user identity during login;
- Maintaining secure account access;
- Managing authentication sessions.

Login Security

- Detecting suspicious login attempts;
- Preventing unauthorized access;
- Protecting user credentials.

Profile Management

- Maintaining account records;
 - Supporting role-based functionality;
 - Enabling profile customization and updates.
-

5.2 Platform Operations

User information is processed to support the core functionalities of SpareXchange.

Spare Exchange

Information may be used to:

- Create and manage spare listings;
- Facilitate exchange coordination;
- Enable search and filtering functionality;
- Support user communication regarding spare parts.

Technician Coordination

Information may be used to:

- Process technician requests;

- Coordinate repair-related interactions;
- Manage technician availability;
- Facilitate communication between users and technicians.

Recycling Workflows

Information may be used to:

- Process recycling submissions;
 - Coordinate recycler activities;
 - Track eco-point eligibility;
 - Support environmentally responsible reuse activities.
-

5.3 Verification and Trust

SpareXchange processes information to improve trust and reduce misuse of platform services.

Information may be used for:

User Verification

- Reviewing verification requests;
- Determining eligibility for restricted features;
- Validating technician or recycler participation.

Fraud Prevention

- Detecting suspicious activities;

- Preventing identity misuse;
- Reducing deceptive or fraudulent behavior.

Verification processes are intended to improve safety and reliability across the platform.

5.4 Communication

SpareXchange may use collected information to facilitate communication and user support.

This may include:

Notifications

- Verification status updates;
- Technician request notifications;
- Recycling-related updates;
- Platform activity alerts.

Support Messages

- Responding to user inquiries;
 - Resolving reported issues;
 - Providing technical or administrative assistance.
-

5.5 Security

User information may be used to maintain platform safety and prevent harmful activity.

This includes:

Threat Detection

- Monitoring suspicious behavior;
- Identifying unauthorized access attempts;
- Investigating security incidents.

Abuse Prevention

- Detecting policy violations;
 - Preventing harassment or misuse;
 - Supporting moderation and dispute management.
-

5.6 System Improvement

SpareXchange may process limited technical and usage information to improve system quality and performance.

This may include:

Performance Monitoring

- Monitoring system reliability;
- Improving responsiveness;
- Identifying performance bottlenecks.

Bug Fixing

- Diagnosing technical errors;
- Resolving system malfunctions;
- Improving user experience and functionality.

SpareXchange aims to use collected information responsibly and only where reasonably necessary for operational purposes.

6. Legal Basis for Processing Information

SpareXchange processes user information only for legitimate, necessary, and lawful purposes related to platform functionality, security, operational effectiveness, and compliance obligations.

Information may be processed on the following grounds:

6.1 Platform Functionality

User information may be processed where necessary to provide core SpareXchange services and enable platform operations.

This includes:

- Account creation and management;
- Spare listing functionality;

- Technician coordination;
- Recycling workflows;
- Eco-point management;
- Dispute resolution;
- Notification services.

Without certain information, some platform features may not function properly.

6.2 User Consent

Certain information may be processed based on user consent.

Consent may be provided when users:

- Register an account;
- Submit profile information;
- Upload verification documents;
- Participate in technician or recycler workflows;
- Voluntarily communicate through the platform.

Users may choose not to provide optional information; however, this may limit access to some platform functionalities.

6.3 Security and Platform Protection

SpareXchange may process information to:

- Prevent unauthorized access;
- Detect fraud or misuse;
- Protect user accounts;
- Investigate suspicious activities;
- Maintain platform integrity.

Security-related processing is essential for maintaining a trustworthy platform environment.

6.4 Legitimate Operational Purposes

Information may be processed to support legitimate operational needs of SpareXchange.

This may include:

- Performance monitoring;
- Troubleshooting;
- Service improvement;
- Moderation activities;
- Administrative review.

Processing is limited to purposes reasonably necessary for platform operation.

6.5 Legal Obligations

SpareXchange may process or disclose information where required to comply with applicable Ethiopian laws, lawful requests, regulatory obligations, or authorized investigations.

This may include cooperation with legally competent authorities where required.

7. Data Sharing and Disclosure

SpareXchange values user privacy and seeks to limit unnecessary disclosure of personal information.

SpareXchange does not sell, rent, or commercially trade users' personal information to third parties.

However, limited information sharing may occur where necessary to support platform functionality, trust, security, or legal compliance.

7.1 Information Shared with Administrators

Authorized administrators may access limited user information where necessary for:

- Verification review;
- Moderation;
- Dispute resolution;
- Fraud prevention;
- Security monitoring.

Administrative access is restricted and role-based to minimize unnecessary exposure of user information.

7.2 Information Shared with Technicians and Recyclers

Certain information may be shared between users, technicians, or recyclers where necessary to facilitate platform interactions.

Examples may include:

Technician Coordination

- Service request details;
- Basic communication information;
- Availability-related information.

Recycling Coordination

- Recycling submissions;
- Recycler communication details;
- Eco-point-related activities.

Only information reasonably necessary for coordination shall be shared.

7.3 Information Shared with Legal Authorities

SpareXchange may disclose information where legally required or reasonably necessary to:

- Comply with Ethiopian law;
- Respond to lawful government requests;
- Investigate fraud or unlawful conduct;
- Protect platform users or security.

Disclosures shall be limited to what is legally necessary.

7.4 Information Shared with Service Providers

SpareXchange may rely on trusted third-party providers to support platform operations.

Limited information may be processed by service providers for purposes such as:

- Cloud hosting;
- File storage;
- Email notifications;
- Authentication support;
- Infrastructure maintenance.

Service providers are expected to process information responsibly and only for authorized operational purposes.

8. Third-Party Services and Integrations

SpareXchange may integrate external technologies or service providers to support platform functionality, reliability, and performance.

Third-party services may include:

- Map or geolocation services;
- Cloud hosting infrastructure;
- File storage systems;
- Email or notification services;
- Authentication services.

These integrations help support features such as:

- Location-based recycler discovery;
- Secure file storage;
- Account authentication;
- Platform communication;
- System reliability.

Although SpareXchange seeks to work with reputable providers, **third-party services may maintain independent privacy practices and policies beyond SpareXchange's direct control.**

Users are encouraged to review relevant third-party privacy policies where applicable.

SpareXchange shall not be responsible for privacy practices, policies, or actions conducted independently by third-party service providers.